

Zhuocheng (Tom) Qiao

AI Agent Engineer / AI Backend Engineer

Shanghai | M.S., Signal and Information Processing, East China Normal University (2022)
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SUMMARY

Software Engineer II at Microsoft with 4+ years of experience building AI agent runtimes, agent harnesses, backend platforms, and production-grade distributed systems. Experienced in technical design, core implementation, cross-team delivery, and operation of enterprise AI products.

EXPERIENCE

Microsoft | Software Engineer II | Jun 2022-Present

Office Agent (Societas) | General-Purpose Agent Platform | Jul 2025-Jan 2026

A general-purpose agent for Microsoft 365 Personal and Family subscribers, reaching **27K WAU**—approximately 8.5% of eligible users—within two months of global launch; focused on agent runtime, productionization, reliability, and compliance.

- **Native Tool Calling:** Led the migration from text-based XML tool invocation to native function calling, introducing dual-mode rollout and rollback, while extending support across the complete sub-agent tree for reliable, cross-model execution.
- **User-Level Encryption:** Authored the design and protocol for a user-level encryption system — hierarchical keys, stable hashed lookup, ciphertext format & versioning, and key rotation — on top of which partner modules encrypted EUID and customer-content fields across core tables (Accounts, Messages, Projects), enabling compliance and zero-downtime migration of existing plaintext data.
- **Reliable Message Delivery:** Independently redesigned long-running agent messaging around durable database state, lightweight notifications, idempotent incremental recovery, and ordered Service Bus sessions, making transient disconnects recoverable.
- **Agent Proxy:** Independently designed and delivered Agent Proxy to production end-to-end — OBO auth, task persistence, restart recovery, TLS, containers, CI/CD — enabling agent capabilities to be reliably integrated by external systems as a standalone service.

Microsoft Copilot / Epichan | AI Harness & Production Engineering | Jan 2026-Present

Contributed to the evolution from Microsoft Copilot Studio toward the agent-first Epichan engineering system, covering vertical harness workflows, platform migration, and production delivery.

- **Agent Harness:** Independently abstracted accessibility remediation into the studio-bugfix workflow before a common harness existed, then integrated this capability into an Epichan label-routed vertical workflow; closed **64 Sev2 issues** in two months and supported EAA compliance.
- **Pipeline Migration (GitHub→Azure DevOps):** Owned migration of the majority of Epichan's pipelines — including numerous Azure-native service integrations — from GitHub Actions to Azure DevOps, resolving cross-platform differences in build, artifacts, and permissions so that Epichan's agent harness continued running without disruption after cutover.
- **Release Pipeline Optimization:** Redesigned the pre-prod→production promotion flow to build artifacts once and promote validated pre-prod images directly to prod, eliminating redundant production rebuilds and shortening release time; delivered within Microsoft Copilot's production system (immutable artifacts, progressive rollout, automated gates, feature flags, kill switches, rollback, regional failover).

Office Plus | Commercial Backend Platform | Dec 2024-Jul 2025

Multi-service commercialization platform built with .NET/ABP and Azure, spanning orders, payments, entitlements, identity, and third-party integrations.

- **Plagiarism-Checking Commercialization:** Led end-to-end productization across file upload, orders, payments, entitlements, asynchronous processing, result delivery, retries, and automatic refunds; processed **6,320 orders** in the first **10 days**.
- **Identity & Session Governance:** Led account soft deletion, refresh-token modernization, and device-session governance, reducing record growth from **MAU x devices x 30** to **MAU x devices** while supporting quotas, revocation, and gradual migration.

Earlier Projects: XPay (Jun-Oct 2022) | PC Manager Client (Oct 2022-Dec 2024)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Agent Engineering: Function Calling, Multi-Agent/Sub-Agent, Agent Harnesses, Skills, Tool Orchestration, Context & Memory, Automated Evaluation & Quality Gates

Backend: Python, FastAPI, C#/ .NET, Java, REST/SSE, Distributed Tasks & Asynchronous Processing

Infrastructure: Azure, Service Bus, Redis, PostgreSQL, Docker, CI/CD, Logging & Observability

OPEN-SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

Contributed to popular open-source projects including Hermes Agent and Multica, with **10+ fixes** merged or incorporated upstream across agent security, runtime reliability, tenant isolation, and API robustness; experienced in issue discovery, root-cause analysis, patches, tests, and maintainer collaboration.